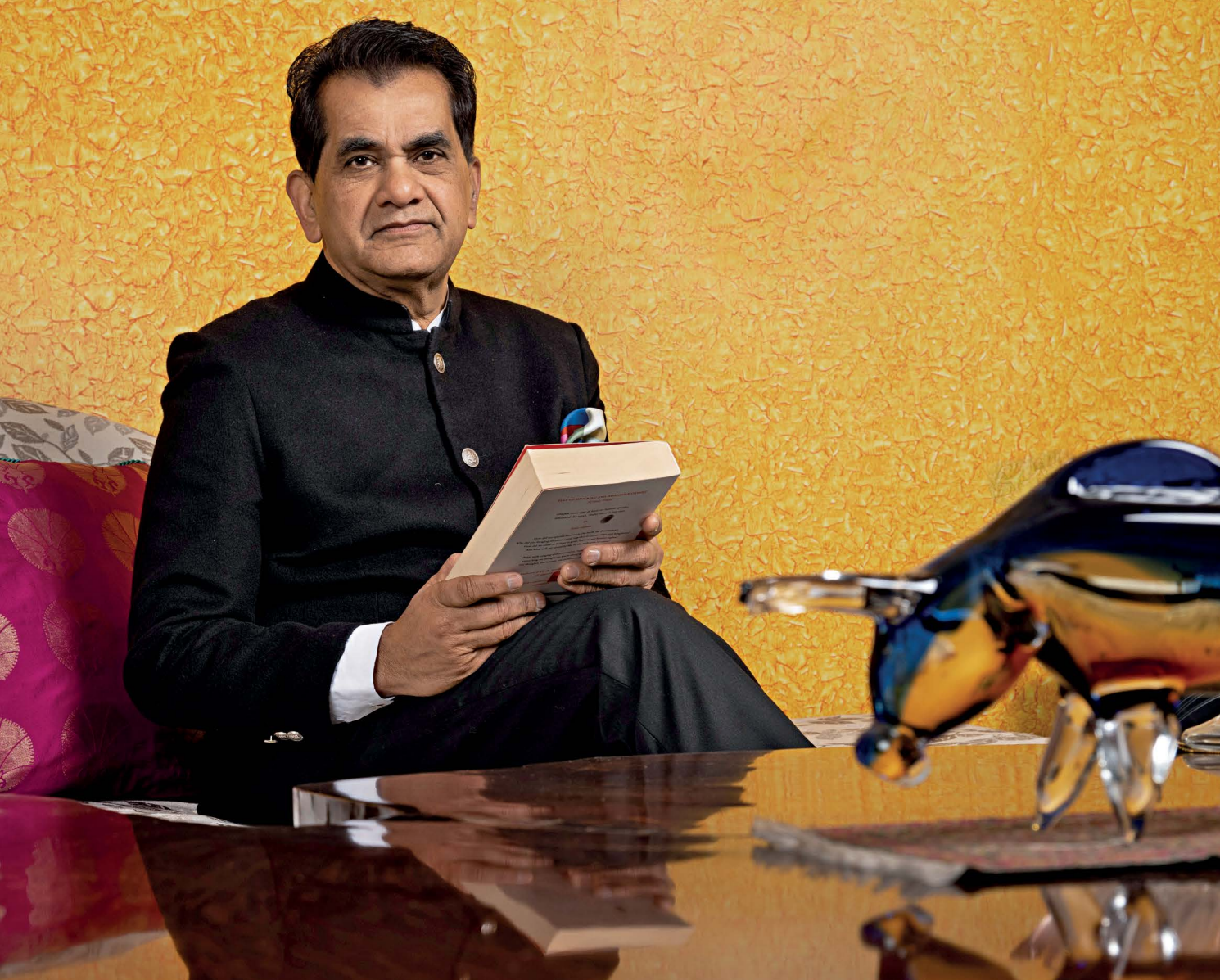




THIRST FOR KNOWLEDGE For Amitabh Kant, reading is a passion. He likes to keep himself updated with the latest trends and learn new things

bai Industrial Development Corporation (2009-14); Secretary, Department of Industrial Policy and Promotion (2014-16); and the Chief Executive Officer of the NITI Aayog (2016-22).

Throughout his career, he has helped mould and take forward flagship national initiatives such as Startup India, Make in India, Incredible India, Kerala: God's Own Country and the Aspirational Districts programme.

But perhaps his most successful stint has been as India's G20 Sherpa. Kant was appointed to the role in July 2022, months ahead of India assuming the presidency of this multilateral forum from December 1, 2022, to November 30, 2023. He took over from Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal, when the need was felt for a full-time G20 Sherpa.

BRINGING G20 TO THE PEOPLE

When India assumed the G20 presidency, not many in the country were aware of what the G20 was or what the role of the Sherpa entailed. But by the end of India's presidency, G20 was a household term with meetings being held in as many as 60 locations across the country. And the presidency is considered a bona fide success, delivering the Delhi Declaration at the Leaders' Summit in New Delhi in September despite concerns and a sharp global divide over the Russia-Ukraine war.

Kant recalls that there were a number of challenges when India took over the presidency. "There was a global slowdown—75 countries were in a debt crisis; it was the post-Covid era and only 12% of the sustainable development goals (SDGs) were on track. And